Jazzy Chord-Planing Boom-Bap

Sounds like: Doechii "Denial Is a River"

ACCURACY B

Close enough to fool most ears.

NOT YET TESTED - settings are a starting point; trust your ears

WHAT YOU NEED (in this order)

`E-piano patch (ID8 or NN-XT Rhodes) -> Scream 4 (Tape) -> boom-bap kit (Kong/Redrum) + ReGroove -> SubTractor bass -> dry rap vocal`

Starting material: MIDI + a rap vocal; no samples needed

DO THIS, STEP BY STEP

1. The chord: build ONE dominant-13 in spread voicing — from bottom: A, G, C#, F#, B (root, flat-7, 3, 13, 9). Program it once in the sequencer on an e-piano sound (ID8 E-Piano or an NN-XT Rhodes patch).

2. The planing trick: copy that whole chord block and drag the copies — down a half-step (Ab13), down again (G13), once more (F#13). Two-bar loop. Do NOT correct notes to the key; moving the shape intact IS the sound. This is how the actual record was made, just in a different DAW.

3. Rhythm of the chords: hit them in a 3+3+2 pattern (count "one-two-three, one-two-three, one-two") rather than on downbeats. That off-balance push is half the groove.

4. Tone: Scream 4 after the e-piano, Tape, Damage 20–30 — dusty, slightly compressed, early-90s sampler warmth. Small RV7000 room, barely audible.

5. Drums: sparse boom-bap kit. Snare on 2 and 4, nudged a few ticks LATE. Kicks deliberately loose — the original's kicks are "drunken." Reason move: push the drum track through a ReGroove channel with shuffle around 54–58% instead of quantizing.

6. Bass: SubTractor, waveform 3 (triangle), following the chord roots down: A, Ab, G, F#. Short notes, locked to the kick.

7. Vocal: dry and upfront (use the Upfront Rap Vocal recipe). For the inner-dialogue second voice: duplicate track, pan ~30% off-center, MClass EQ — cut below 300 Hz and above 5 kHz for a boxy "voice in your head" contrast.

Why this works

Four unresolvable dominant-13 chords in parallel create rich tension that never lands — a mood bed that lets the rap carry all the direction.

Why this order

Write chords before drums: the 3+3+2 chord rhythm defines where the drums should NOT hit.

Reason trick
ReGroove Mixer is the platform advantage here — per-channel shuffle and slide gets the drunken-kick feel no grid quantize can. Save the e-piano + Scream + RV7000 as a Combinator: "Golden EP.cmb".

The skill you just learned
Chord planing: one good voicing, copied chromatically, beats an hour of theory.

Worth buying?
None. This one is genuinely all-stock.

Listen to the real song: Doechii — "Denial Is a River" (prod. Ian James/Joey Hamhock/Banser): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=f-OWO1aZz0g